Novel Views of a Person from 125 Photos: NeRF, TensoRF, 3DGS and Mip-Splatting

Anas Khan MBZUAI CV802 Sub-project 3: Novel-view Synthesis



Figure 1. Three of the 16 held-out photos (not used in training) next to each method's render from the same camera.

Method	PSNR↑	SSIM↑	LPIPS↓	Train (min)	FPS↑	Primitives	MB
NeRF [1]	26.59	0.931	0.132	60	0.04	1.2M	14
TensoRF [2]	26.35	0.938	0.130	42	0.98	17.4M	67
3DGS [3]	26.63	0.951	0.072	**16**	373	149k	35
Mip-Splatting [4]	**27.62**	**0.958**	**0.067**	31	**569**	197k	47

Table 1. Held-out photos (16, 750×1000): PSNR [dB], SSIM [5], LPIPS (VGG) [6], training minutes (runs shared one RTX 5000 Ada), images per second, primitives (Gaussians or network/grid values), MB. Best in bold.

Rendered at	3DGS	Mip-Splatting
1/4 size (zoom out)	23.71 / 0.055	**28.63** / 0.028
1× (training size)	26.63 / 0.072	**27.62** / 0.067
1.6× (zoom in)	26.29 / 0.090	**27.37** / 0.084

Table 2. Zoom test: PSNR / LPIPS rendered at other sizes. Truth: photo averaged down ($\frac{1}{4}$) or the 1600 px original (1.6×).

1 Task and data

Draw a person from *new* viewpoints (preset-path video, interactive viewer). Input: only the 125 photos (four iPhone lenses, video frames) and the cameras Sub-project 1 recovered with VGGSfM [7], undistorted; person masks give a white background; 1000 px. Every 8th photo (16) is held out, as in [3].

2 Methods

NeRF [1] and TensoRF [2] render a pixel by summing density σ_i and colour c_i along its ray, $C = \sum_i T_i(1 - e^{-\sigma_i \delta_i})c_i$, $T_i = \prod_{j<i} e^{-\sigma_j \delta_j}$. NeRF asks one MLP (8×256, positional encoding, coarse then fine samples); TensoRF a 3D feature grid factorised into planes times lines (VM decomposition) and a tiny MLP. **3D Gaussian Splatting [3]** stores the scene as 3D Gaussians (position, covariance Σ, opacity, spherical-harmonics colour), started at 100k random points in the scene box and densified while training. Each is projected to a 2D Gaussian $\Sigma' = JW\Sigma W^\top J^\top$ (EWA splatting [8]), sorted by depth and alpha-blended: real time. **Mip-Splatting [4]** adds a 3D smoothing filter (no Gaussian finer than the photos sample) and a 2D Mip filter instead of 3DGS's fixed screen-space dilation, so renders at other zoom levels do not alias.

All use the authors' code (NeRF: nerf-pytorch, the PyTorch port of the original), white background, 30k iterations; NeRF 1 h (44k steps; the paper 200k+). Extra: 3DGS with the room (17.96 dB).

3 Results

Table 1, Fig. 1: Mip-Splatting is the most faithful (27.62 dB, LPIPS 0.067). 3DGS (26.63) ties NeRF (26.59) and TensoRF (26.35 dB) in PSNR but is far sharper (LPIPS 0.072 vs 0.132, 0.130), and the Gaussian methods draw at 373–569 images per second while the ray marchers need seconds per image. Table 2 tests the claim of [4]: at a quarter of the size 3DGS falls to 23.71 dB, its Gaussians thinner than a pixel, while Mip-Splatting keeps 28.63 dB. Ablation: starting from the Sub-project 1 point cloud instead of random points gives 27.53 (3DGS), 27.53 (Mip-Splatting) and 19.71 dB (room): it helps 3DGS and the room, not Mip-Splatting.

4 Interactive viewer in the starter code

The course's Open3D [9] GUI of Sub-project 1 gains a novel-view panel, like Nerfstudio [10]: the 3D view's camera is converted to a pinhole camera, the selected model is rendered from it on a worker thread and shown behind the scene, so dragging, panning and zooming move the novel view (preview while moving, full size when still). It shows the held-out photo, exports MP4s along a preset orbit or keyframes (Catmull-Rom, slerp) and runs our Sub-project 2 Screened Poisson [11] on the open points, rasterising the mesh in the same view. For laptops without CUDA, the official renderers' inference is re-done in plain PyTorch (CUDA, Apple MPS, CPU); it matches them at 105 and 103 dB PSNR (identical).

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